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# Windows CMD & Run Commands

**Use this when:** you need a Windows tool fast: open a console with **Win + R** or fix a PC from the command line.

CompTIA A+ Core 2 (220-1202)  
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## Run box launchers

Pro/Enterprise only: lusrmgr.msc, gpedit.msc

**Win** + **R** then type the name · **Ctrl** + **Shift** + **Enter** runs it as admin

|                                       |                                       |                                     |                                      |                                        |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>devmgmt.msc</b><br>Device Manager  | <b>services.msc</b><br>Services       | <b>eventvwr.msc</b><br>Event Viewer | <b>compmgmt.msc</b><br>Computer Mgmt | <b>diskmgmt.msc</b><br>Disk Management |
| <b>taskschd.msc</b><br>Task Scheduler | <b>lusrmgr.msc</b><br>Local users     | <b>gpedit.msc</b><br>Local policy   | <b>appwiz.cpl</b><br>Programs        | <b>ncpa.cpl</b><br>Network adapters    |
| <b>sysdm.cpl</b><br>System properties | <b>msinfo32</b><br>System Information | <b>resmon</b><br>Resource Monitor   | <b>perfmon</b><br>Performance Mon.   | <b>msconfig</b><br>Boot / startup      |
| <b>cleanmgr</b><br>Disk Cleanup       | <b>mstsc</b><br>Remote Desktop        | <b>control</b><br>Control Panel     | <b>winver</b><br>Windows version     | <b>regedit</b><br>Registry: Danger     |

## Network

|                                          |                     |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>ipconfig /all</b>                     | IP, DNS, MAC, lease |
| <b>ipconfig /release</b> · <b>/renew</b> | new DHCP lease      |
| <b>ipconfig /flushdns</b>                | clear DNS cache     |
| <b>ping -n 4 192.0.2.1</b>               | reachable?          |
| <b>tracert</b> · <b>pathping</b>         | where it breaks     |
| <b>nslookup example.com</b>              | DNS answer          |
| <b>netstat -ano</b>                      | ports + PID         |
| <b>net use Z: \\srv\share</b>            | map a drive         |

## System & repair

|                                                   |                     |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>sfc /scannow</b>                               | repair system files |
| <b>DISM /Online /Cleanup-Image /RestoreHealth</b> |                     |
| <b>chkdsk C: /f</b>                               | fix disk errors     |
| <b>systeminfo</b>                                 | OS, uptime, patches |
| <b>whoami</b> · <b>hostname</b>                   | who and where       |
| <b>gpupdate /force</b>                            | reapply policy      |
| <b>gpresult /r</b>                                | policies applied    |
| <b>net user jdoe /domain</b>                      | locked? pwd expiry  |

## Processes & power

|                              |                   |
|------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>tasklist</b>              | running processes |
| <b>taskkill /PID 4321 /f</b> | force close       |
| <b>shutdown /r /t 0</b>      | restart now       |
| <b>shutdown /a</b>           | cancel shutdown   |

**CAUTION** **/f** and **/release** can lose unsaved work or drop a remote session. **chkdsk C: /f** runs at the next reboot. Tell the user first.

## Danger zone

**DANGER** These erase or overwrite data. Double-check the drive letter or path and have a backup.

|                              |                                  |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>format D:</b>             | wipes the volume                 |
| <b>diskpart → clean</b>      | deletes every partition          |
| <b>robocopy src dst /MIR</b> | deletes extra files at dst       |
| <b>del /s /q *.*</b>         | deletes silently, no Recycle Bin |
| <b>regedit</b>               | one wrong key can stop boot      |
| <b>cmd /?</b> shows help     | <b>Tab</b> completes paths       |
| <b>  clip</b> copies output  | <b>&gt; log.txt</b> saves it     |

**REMEMBER** ● Run **DISM** first, then **sfc /scannow** if files are corrupt  
● **.msc** = console snap-in · **.cpl** = Control Panel item

● **169.254.x.x** after **/renew** = no DHCP server reply  
● Use an admin prompt only for the task, then close it